

NEWS 2 NOTES

Current Affairs Series

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ANJION
LEARNING



INDEX

	Topic Name	Category	Page no
1	Vasundhara Tal – First Glacial Lake Early Warning System	Disaster Management / Geography	1
2	PRAMAAN Certificate	Environment / Schemes	2
3	Mandar – GI Tag	Art & Culture	3
4	Didymocarpus nautiyalii	Environment / Biodiversity	4
5	Galaxy Frog	Environment / Biodiversity	5
6	MCQ Practice Section	Practice	7



Vasundhara Tal – First Glacial Lake Early Warning System

Why in News: Uttarakhand has started installing its first real-time glacial lake early warning system at Vasundhara Tal in Chamoli district.

Key Facts

Vasundhara Tal

Vasundhara Tal is a high-altitude **glacial lake in Chamoli district, Uttarakhand**. It has been identified as a high-risk lake.

GLOF Risk Reduction

The system aims to reduce the risk of **GLOF (Glacial Lake Outburst Flood)**, which is a sudden flood caused when a glacial lake bursts.

Technology Used

It uses **sensors, satellite communication and real-time data**, and it sends alerts when danger levels are crossed.

Uttarakhand's Glacial Lakes

Uttarakhand has 344 glacial lakes, based on NRSC 2023 data. Of these, **13 have been identified as high-risk lakes by the NDMA and technical institutions.**

Implementing Agencies

The system is being installed with **CBRI (Central Building Research Institute), Roorkee**. C-DAC is also developing a similar system for the same lake.



PRAMAAN Certificate

Why in News: Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav handed over India's first PRAMAAN certificates under the Indian Forest and Wood Certification Scheme (IFWCS).

Key Facts

PRAMAAN Brand

PRAMAAN is the certification brand of the **Indian Forest and Wood Certification Scheme (IFWCS)**. It covers forests, wood and non-timber forest products.

Launch & Operating Agency

IFWCS was launched by the MoEFCC in December 2023. IIFM (Indian Institute of Forest Management), Bhopal is its operating agency.

First Certificates

The **first certificates** went to the **Andhra Pradesh Forest Development Corporation** for 33,000 hectares of plantations, and to **Govind Mohapatra**, a farmer linked to the **Odisha Bamboo Development Agency**.

Three Types of Certification

It offers **three types of certification: Forest Management, Trees Outside Forests (TOF) Management**, and **Chain of Custody**.

Global Regulatory Compliance

It helps Indian exporters meet emerging global regulatory requirements and due diligence norms for **deforestation-free timber**, such as the EU Deforestation Regulation (EUDR).



Mandar – GI Tag

Why in News: Jharkhand's traditional musical instrument Mandar has received a Geographical Indication (GI) tag.

Key Facts

What is Mandar?

Mandar is a traditional **percussion (drum) instrument of Jharkhand**. It is played during tribal and folk festivals, harvest celebrations and dances.

Physical Description

Its body is **cylindrical and made of red clay**, and it is slightly bulging in the middle.

GI Registration

It is registered as **"Mandar of Jharkhand"** by the **Geographical Indications Registry, Chennai**.

Applicant

The applicant was the **Raidih Mandar Producer Company Limited** from **Gumla district**.

Legal Framework

GI tags are granted under the **Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) Act, 1999**.



Didymocarpus nautiyalii

Why in News: Botanists discovered a new plant species, *Didymocarpus nautiyalii*, in Arunachal Pradesh's Shi-Yomi district.

Key Facts

Location of Discovery

It was found in **Shi-Yomi district, Arunachal Pradesh,** which is part of the **Eastern Himalaya.**

Plant Family

It belongs to the family **Gesneriaceae**, also called the **African violet family.**

Named After

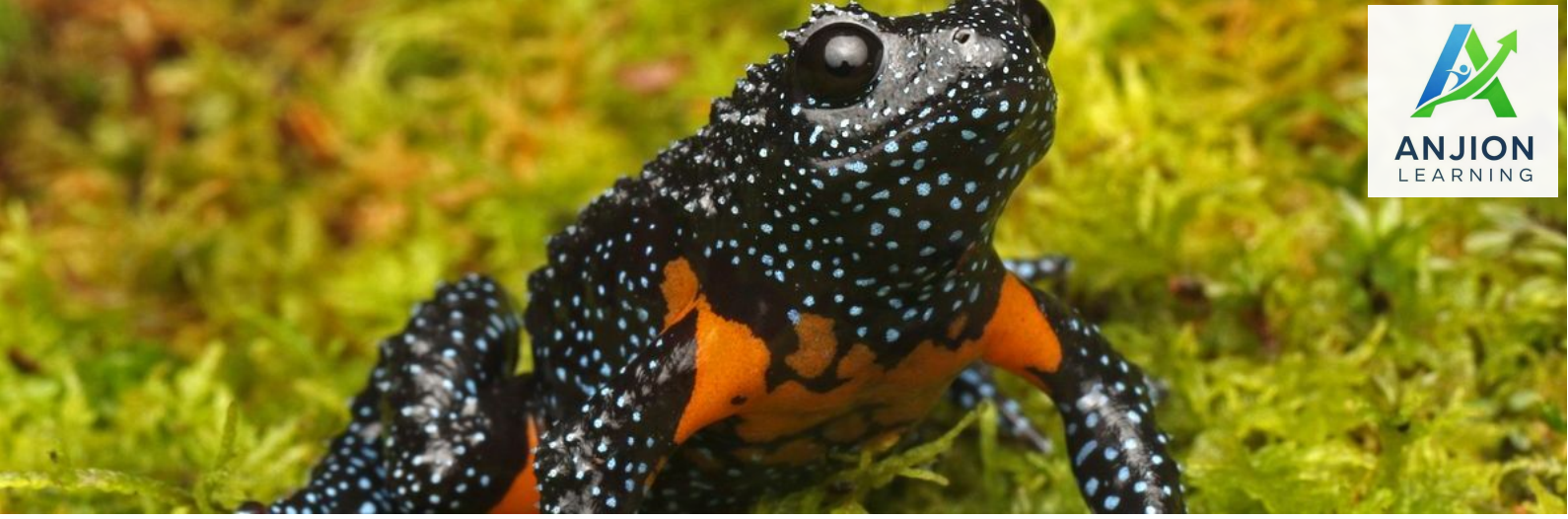
It is named after **Prof. Sunil Nautiyal**, former Director of the **G.B. Pant National Institute of Himalayan Environment (GBPNIHE).**

Population & IUCN Status

Only **19 flowering plants in two small populations** have been recorded. The researchers assessed it as **Data Deficient** using IUCN criteria.

Scientific Publication

It was formally described in the scientific journal **Taiwania.**



Galaxy Frog

Why in News: New images of the rarely seen Galaxy frog were shared by Supriya Sahu, Additional Chief Secretary of Tamil Nadu's Environment, Climate Change and Forests Department.

Key Facts

Scientific Classification

Its scientific name is **Melanobatrachus indicus**, and it belongs to the family **Microhylidae**.

Habitat & Endemism

It is **endemic to the southern Western Ghats of Kerala and Tamil Nadu**.

Discovery History

It was first described in **1878 from the Anamalai Hills**, and it was rediscovered in **1997**.

Distinctive Appearance

It has **black skin with bluish-white star-like spots**, which gives it the name "Galaxy" frog.

Conservation Status

It is the **only species in its genus** and is listed as an **EDGE species** (Evolutionarily Distinct and Globally Endangered) by ZSL. On the IUCN Red List it has recently been reassessed from Endangered to Vulnerable.



MCQ PRACTICE

Q1. The first glacial lake early warning system in Uttarakhand is being installed at Vasundhara Tal in which district?

(a) Pithoragarh (b) Uttarkashi (c) Chamoli (d) Rudraprayag

Answer: (c) Chamoli
Explanation: Vasundhara Tal is a high-risk glacial lake in Chamoli district. The system uses sensors and satellite data to warn of Glacial Lake Outburst Floods.

Q2. Which institution is the operating agency of the Indian Forest and Wood Certification Scheme (PRAMAAN)?

(a) Forest Research Institute, Dehradun (b) Indian Institute of Forest Management, Bhopal

(c) Forest Survey of India, Dehradun (d) Wildlife Institute of India, Dehradun

Answer: (b) Indian Institute of Forest Management, Bhopal
Explanation: IIFM Bhopal runs the IFWCS, which the MoEFCC launched in December 2023. The first PRAMAAN certificates went to APFDC and an Odisha bamboo farmer.

Q3. "Mandar", which recently received a GI tag, is a traditional musical instrument of which state?

(a) Odisha (b) Chhattisgarh (c) West Bengal (d) Jharkhand

Answer: (d) Jharkhand
Explanation: Mandar is a red-clay percussion instrument used in Jharkhand's tribal and folk traditions. It is registered as "Mandar of Jharkhand" by the GI Registry, Chennai.

Q4. Didymocarpus nautiyalii, a new plant species, was recently discovered in which state?

(a) Sikkim (b) Arunachal Pradesh (c) Meghalaya (d) Mizoram

Answer: (b) Arunachal Pradesh
Explanation: It was discovered in Shi-Yomi district of Arunachal Pradesh and belongs to the Gesneriaceae family. It is named after Prof. Sunil Nautiyal, former Director of GBPNIHE.

Q5. The Galaxy frog (*Melanobatrachus indicus*) is endemic to which region of India?

(a) Eastern Himalaya (b) Aravalli Hills

(c) Southern Western Ghats (d) Andaman and Nicobar Islands

Answer: (c) Southern Western Ghats
Explanation: The Galaxy frog is found only in the southern Western Ghats of Kerala and Tamil Nadu. It is the only species in its genus.